

8.4. Reading from a file

To read information from a file, it is necessary to know the basic function used to open a file. Look at the example below:

```
$myFile = "testFile.txt";  
$fh = fopen($myFile, 'r');
```

This function will open the file and you can read it. The 'fread()' function reads data from a file. This function requires a file handle along with an integer to command how much data in bytes should read at a time.

Basically, the fgets() function reads each line from a file. Read the example below:

```
<?php  
$file_ptr = fopen("welcomefile.txt", "r") or  
exit("Unable to open file!");  
//Output a line of the file until the end is  
reached  
  
while(!feof($file_ptr))  
{  
    echo fgets($file_ptr). "<br />";  
}  
fclose($file_ptr);  
?>
```

The above example describes how a function can be used to read a file line by line. The example below would focus on how a file can be read character by character:

Look at the code below:

```
<?php  
$file_ptr = fopen("welcomefile.txt", "r") or  
exit("Unable to open file!");  
while (!feof($file_ptr))  
{  
    echo fgetc($file_ptr);  
}  
fclose($file_ptr);  
?>
```